

STEVE CUMMINS

Principal / Chief Marketer, Solent Strategies

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WHEN • HELD, NOT BOOKED

SESSION 7
FRI, SEPT 25 • 12:30 PM ET

FORMAT

PRESENTATION*
WITH SLIDES, THEN Q&A

LENGTH

30 MINUTES
VIRTUAL

YOUR TITLE

Marketing that Maps the Customer Journey

OUR SUGGESTION

Yours is good. We would publish it exactly as written.

DEFAULT EVENT COPY

This is what we will publish on the event page.
If you would like it adjusted, send us the revisions.

ABOUT THIS SESSION

Every founder is told to do marketing, and everyone they ask has a different opinion. Steve Cummins, a fractional CMO with more than 20 years in B2B marketing, starts from the classic marketing funnel and shows which tactics belong at which stage, then makes the case that the customer journey is no longer linear and needs a more nuanced read. The session closes on the one or two things worth doing well rather than covering every base.

TAKEAWAYS

- Define the goal of your marketing, then match tactics to each stage
- What has to be in place before you spend: a clear message, a defined reachable audience
- Do one or two things well rather than covering every base

WHO IT IS FOR

Founders who are pre-revenue and testing the market, already generating revenue, or raising. Useful to anyone who knows they should be marketing and has neither the time nor the budget to do all of it.

ABOUT STEVE

Steve helps growing businesses punch above their weight, working with companies who are ready to take marketing seriously but are not ready for a full time CMO. That means developing the right message, reaching a broader audience, and executing a marketing plan tailored for their business. Steve has an engineering background and more than 20 years experience in global B2B marketing with name-brand companies and feisty start-ups. He also coaches and mentors marketers and teams of one.

A RESOURCE STEVE RECOMMENDS

A one-pager built for this session, plus an 8-page eBook, Building a Realistic Marketing Strategy.

WHAT'S NEXT

Calendar hold	For the educational session only. Lands as soon as you confirm the date.
Sync call	15 minutes the week before. We will coordinate a time with you.
Your 30 minutes	Roughly 20 minutes of content, then questions. We hold the clock.

**Slides only. If you are presenting, the final deck is due 72 hours before the session.*

ERIC SCHMALZBAUER

Former co-founder & CEO, Prospective

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WHEN • HELD, NOT BOOKED

SESSION 2
MON, SEPT 14 • 12:30 PM ET

FORMAT

FIRESIDE CHAT
MODERATED, THEN QUESTIONS

LENGTH

30 MINUTES
VIRTUAL

YOUR TITLE

B2B: from idea > funding > failure

OUR SUGGESTION

Yours is good. We would publish it exactly as written.

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ABOUT THIS SESSION

Founders hear success stories constantly and almost never a first-hand account of the other outcome. Eric Schmalzbauer walks the whole arc of his venture-backed B2B startup as a first-time founder: the idea, the fundraising, building the team, and when and why to close up shop, then what he will change for his next business and what he will do more of. Whatever stage you are at the same problems show up, raising money, building a team, getting to market, managing investors. Expect a candid conversation rather than a polished talk.

TAKEAWAYS

- Tangible examples of what worked and what did not inside a venture-backed startup
- As a founder, you always have to be selling, in some form
- Honest acknowledgement that the job is very lonely

WHO IT IS FOR

Any founder in the cohort. Whatever stage you are at, the same problems show up: raising money, building a team, getting to market, and managing investors.

ABOUT ERIC

Eric Schmalzbauer is a technology executive, founder, and venture partner across product strategy, data platforms, and go-to-market execution. He is the now former co-Founder and CEO of Prospective, the team behind the open-source Perspective project, building high-performance tools for interactive data analytics. Eric previously held senior leadership roles across financial market infrastructure and enterprise technology. As a Venture Partner at REFASHIOND Ventures, he advises early-stage founders on product-market fit, fundraising, and scaling.

A RESOURCE ERIC RECOMMENDS

The Workbench Ventures GTM Weekly newsletter, workbench.substack.com/s/gtm-weekly

WHAT'S NEXT

Calendar hold	For the educational session only. Lands as soon as you confirm the date.
Sync call	15 minutes the week before. We will coordinate a time with you.
Your 30 minutes	A 20 to 25 minute moderated conversation, then questions from founders at the end. We hold the clock.

JULIA KAHKY

VP Operations, Tailsight

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WHEN • HELD, NOT BOOKED

SESSION 5
MON, SEPT 21 • 12:30 PM ET

FORMAT

PRESENTATION*
WITH SLIDES, THEN Q&A

LENGTH

30 MINUTES
VIRTUAL

YOUR TITLE

From startup to dissolution: a post-mortem

OUR SUGGESTION

Yours is good. One option: add the subtitle **Selling into enterprise and regulated markets**, so it reads distinctly beside another founder post-mortem in the same series. Entirely your call.

DEFAULT EVENT COPY

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ABOUT THIS SESSION

Everything online talks about how companies succeed, when founders learn far more from avoiding the mistakes of companies that failed. Julia Kahky walks the post-mortem of a startup that closed, specifically what she learned trying to sell software to enterprise customers and into highly regulated markets: what worked, what did not, the problems worth avoiding early, and how long sales cycles really take.

TAKEAWAYS

- Problems to avoid early on
- Product-market fit
- Sales cycles

WHO IT IS FOR

Founders at any stage, from idea through raising, and anyone selling into enterprise or regulated buyers where cycles are long and requirements arrive late.

ABOUT JULIA

Julia Kahky is VP of Operations at a software company in the aviation industry, with prior experience as a chief of staff and in financial technology and operations in sports media. She started her career in finance and has worked across Fortune 15 companies, 500-person companies, and startups, with experience spanning finance, operations, marketing, revenue operations, and HR.

A RESOURCE JULIA RECOMMENDS

The Atrium, a founder community, plus a working list of AI tools, tips and tricks.

WHAT'S NEXT

Calendar hold For the educational session only. Lands as soon as you confirm the date.

Sync call 15 minutes the week before. We will coordinate a time with you.

Your 30 minutes Roughly 20 minutes of content, then questions. We hold the clock.

** Slides only. If you are presenting, the final deck is due 72 hours before the session.*